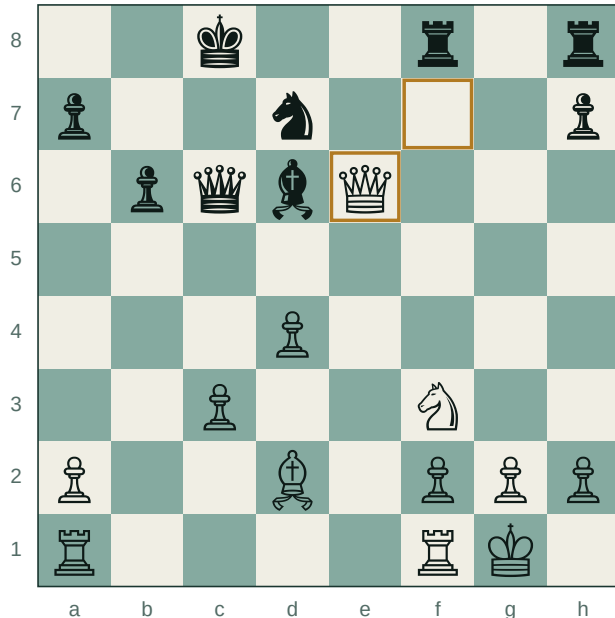


Discovered attacks: Black, move 19

Discovered attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 19.Qxe6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19...Bxh2+ 20. Nxh2 Qxe6

19...Bxh2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on c6 attacks the queen on e6. Recorded reply: **20.Nxh2**.

20...Qxe6 The queen captures the queen on e6.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +7. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +7:** the balance goes from -3 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on e6. Check for tactical protection.